Table 20.1 Organ Systems in Animals

Organ Systems	Organs	Functions
Integumentary system	Skin and skin glands	Protection, Excretion, etc.
Skeletal system	Skull, Vertebral column, Sternum, Girdles and Limbs	Give support, shape and form to the body.
Muscular system	Muscle fibres	Contraction and relaxation resulting movement.
Nervous system	Brain, spinal cord and nerves.	Conduction of nerve impulse.
Circulatory system	Heart, blood and blood vessels	Transportation of respiratory gases, nutritive substances and waste products.
Respiratory system	Respiratory tract and Lungs	Breathing
Digestive system	Digestive tract and digestive glands	Digestion, Absorption, Egestion
Excretory system	Kidneys, ureters, urinary bladder and urethra.	Elimination of nitrogenous waste products.
Reproductive system	Testes and ovary	Gamete formation and development of secondary sexual characters.
Sensory system	Eyes, nose, ears, tongue and skin	Sight, smell, hearing, taste and touch.
Endocrine system	Pituitary, Thyroid, Parathyroid, Adrenals, Pancreas, Pineal body, Thymus, Reproductive glands, etc.	Co-ordinates the functions of all organ systems.

20.1 Human Digestive System

The food we eat contain not only simple substances like vitamins and minerals but also complex substances such as carbohydrates, proteins and fats. The body cannot use these complex substances unless they are converted into simple substances. The five stages of nutrition process include ingestion, digestion, absorption, assimilation and egestion.

The process of nutrition begins with intake of food, called **ingestion**. The breakdown of large complex insoluble food molecules into small, simpler soluble and diffusible particles by the action of digestive enzymes is called **digestion**. Parts of the body concerned with the digestion of food form the **digestive system**.

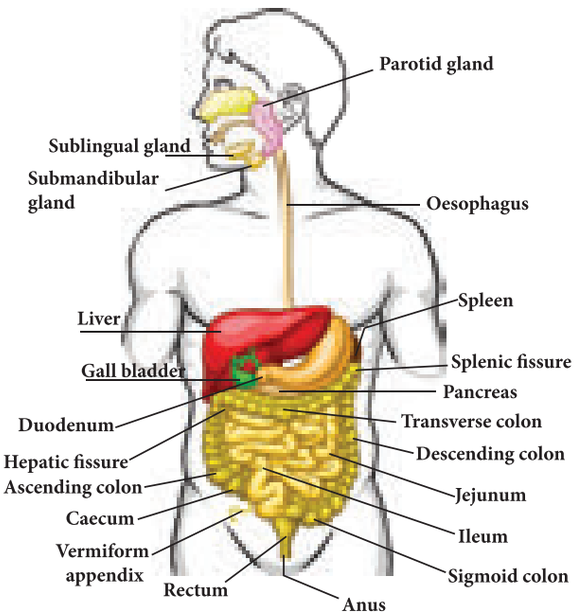


Figure 20.1 Parts of human digestive system

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